

FOUNDATION TOOL

THE SELF-ASSESSMENT CALIBRATION CHECKLIST

Establish Your Personalized Baseline for Safe Movement Progression

CHASE THE DATA, NOT THE SENSATION.

The Movement Re-patterning Toolkit | Dr. Jonathan Schutza, PT, DPT

Baseline Pain Assessment

Record before starting movement checks

Client Information

NAME

DATE

SHOES/CONDITION

Baseline Pain (0-10 scale)

RESTING FOOT PAIN RIGHT NOW

AVERAGE PAIN LAST 24 HOURS

WORST PAIN LAST 24 HOURS

Quick Movement Checks

Perform tests slowly and controlled

1) 3-Minute Walk at Normal Pace

Walk on flat ground at normal work pace for 3 continuous minutes.

LEFT: MINS/DISTANCE

LEFT PAIN (0-10)

RIGHT: MINS/DISTANCE

RIGHT PAIN (0-10)

2) 10 Slow Step-Ups (15-20cm step)

Step up and down with control. One foot leads for 10 reps, then switch.

LEFT REPS

LEFT PAIN (0-10)

RIGHT REPS

RIGHT PAIN (0-10)

3) 10 Single-Leg Heel Raises

Hold light support for balance only; focus on full calf raise using forefoot.

LEFT REPS

LEFT PAIN (0-10)

RIGHT REPS

RIGHT PAIN (0-10)

4) 30-Second Single-Leg Balance

Stand on one leg, hands on hips if possible. Time how long you stay balanced.

LEFT TIME (SEC)

LEFT PAIN (0-10)

RIGHT TIME (SEC)

RIGHT PAIN (0-10)

5) Knee-to-Wall Dorsiflexion

Face wall, toes 10cm from wall, bend knee to touch without heel lifting. Measure distance.

LEFT DISTANCE (CM)

LEFT PAIN (0-10)

RIGHT DISTANCE (CM)

RIGHT PAIN (0-10)

6) 10 Sit-to-Stands

Stand up from chair fully and sit with control, 10 times at steady pace.

REPS COMPLETED

PAIN DURING (0-10)

✓ Calibration Rules

- ✓ **STOP immediately** if sudden sharp, burning, pins/needles, numbness, or swelling
- ✓ **Acceptable for progression:** Pain increases ≤ 2 points AND returns to baseline within 24h AND function not worse
- ✓ **Regression:** If pain > 2 points and worse after 24h OR function worse → reduce load by one step



Progress Increments

Reps/Sets: Add 1-3 reps per session or ~10-20% total reps per week | **Time-based:** Add 1-3 minutes per session every 3-4 days

Intensity: Increase only after volume comfortable for a week | **Always change ONE variable at a time**

Short-Term Plan Builder (2 Weeks)

Pick up to 3 targets to focus on

Target 1 (Priority) | Target 2 | Target 3

FOCUS AREA

BASELINE

2-WEEK GOAL

FOCUS AREA

BASELINE

2-WEEK GOAL

FOCUS AREA

BASELINE

2-WEEK GOAL

2-WEEK GOAL

WEEK 1 PLAN



Red Flags — Stop & Seek Care

- ⚠ New numbness, tingling, or loss of control
- ⚠ Increasing swelling or redness after activity
- ⚠ Severe sharp or burning pain not improving with rest
- ⚠ Pain preventing walking next day